

Ankle Injuries and Disorders

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Summary

Your ankle bone and the ends of your two lower leg bones make up the ankle joint. Your ligaments, which connect bones to one another, stabilize and support it. Your muscles and tendons move it.

The most common ankle problems are sprains and fractures (broken bones). A sprain is an injury to the ligaments. It may take a few weeks to many months to heal completely. A fracture is a break in a bone. You can also injure other parts of the ankle such as tendons, which join muscles to bone, and cartilage, which cushions your joints. Ankle sprains and fractures are common sports injuries.

Start Here

Ankle Pain (Mayo Foundation for Medical Education and Research)

Ankle Problems (American Academy of Family Physicians)

Diagnosis and Tests

Ankle Problems (American Academy of Family Physicians)

Bone X-Ray (American College of Radiology; Radiological Society of North America) Also in Spanish

Direct Arthrography (American College of Radiology; Radiological Society of North America) Also in Spanish

Search the Foot and Ankle Conditions (Interactive Foot Diagram) (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons)

X-Ray Exam: Ankle (For Parents) (Nemours Foundation) Also in Spanish

Prevention and Risk Factors

Prevent Foot and Ankle Running Injuries (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons) - PDF

Treatments and Therapies

Ankle Cheilectomy (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

Distraction Arthroplasty (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

How to Tape an Ankle (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

What Is a Foot and Ankle Surgeon? (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons) Also in Spanish

Living With

Ankle Sprain Treatment (American Academy of Pediatrics) Also in Spanish

Foot and Ankle Conditioning Program (American Academy of Orthopaedic Surgeons) - PDF

How to Strengthen Your Ankle after a Sprain (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

How to Stretch Your Ankle after a Sprain (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

Mobility Aids: MedlinePlus Health Topic (National Library of Medicine) Also in Spanish

Related Issues

Bone Healing (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons) Also in Spanish

Leg Swelling (Mayo Foundation for Medical Education and Research) Also in Spanish

Specifics

Ankle Fractures (Broken Ankle) (American Academy of Orthopaedic Surgeons)

Chronic Ankle Instability (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons)
Also in Spanish

Chronic Lateral Ankle Pain (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

Equinus (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons) Also in Spanish

Os Trigonum Syndrome (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons) Also in Spanish

Osteoarthritis of the Foot and Ankle (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons) Also in Spanish

Peroneal Tendon Injuries (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons)
Also in Spanish

Rheumatoid Arthritis of the Foot and Ankle (American Academy of Orthopaedic Surgeons)

Sinus Tarsi Syndrome (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

Sprains, Strains and Fractures (American Podiatric Medical Association)

Subtalar Arthroscopy (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

Talar Dome Lesion (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons) Also in Spanish

Images

Ankle sprain - Series -- Normal anatomy (Medical Encyclopedia) Also in Spanish

Statistics and Research

Ankle Fractures Often Not Diagnosed (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons)

Smoking and Bone Healing - A Risky Surgical Combination (American College of Foot and Ankle Surgeons)

Clinical Trials

ClinicalTrials.gov: Ankle Injuries (National Institutes of Health)

Journal Articles References and abstracts from MEDLINE/PubMed (National Library of Medicine)

Article: Association of Perioperative Cannabis Use With Postoperative Opioid Consumption in Ankle...

Article: Ultrasonographic Anterior Talofibular Ligament Thickness Does Not Predict Functional Outcomes After...

Article: Evaluation of Chronic Lateral Ankle Instability With an Ankle Sprain Simulator:...

Ankle Injuries and Disorders -- see more articles

Reference Desk

Glossary of Foot and Ankle Terms (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

Find an Expert

American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society

Find a Foot and Ankle Orthopaedic Surgeon (American Orthopaedic Foot and Ankle Society)

National Institute of Arthritis and Musculoskeletal and Skin Diseases Also in Spanish

Children

Sprained Ankles (American Academy of Pediatrics) Also in Spanish

Patient Handouts

Ankle arthroscopy (Medical Encyclopedia) Also in Spanish

Ankle fracture - aftercare (Medical Encyclopedia) Also in Spanish

Ankle pain (Medical Encyclopedia) Also in Spanish

Ankle replacement (Medical Encyclopedia) Also in Spanish

Ankle sprain - aftercare (Medical Encyclopedia) Also in Spanish

Foot, leg, and ankle swelling (Medical Encyclopedia) Also in Spanish

Topic Image

MEDICAL ENCYCLOPEDIA

Ankle arthroscopy

Ankle fracture - aftercare

Ankle pain

Ankle replacement

Ankle replacement - discharge

Ankle sprain - aftercare

Ankle sprain - Series -- Normal anatomy

[Foot, leg, and ankle swelling](#)

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